

political disaster for Abraham Lincoln, whereas Union control could hamper, but not cripple, the Rebel struggle for independence.

 28,700 **The approximate number of American Indians who served either in the Union army or the Confederacy.**

Pea Ridge and Prairie Grove

The Union victory at Pea Ridge opened up much of Arkansas to Union conquest and wrecked Confederate strategic aspirations in the Trans-Mississippi. General Earl Van Dorn and his routed army transferred to the eastern side of the Mississippi in the late spring of 1862. Arkansas now lay open to Federal invasion, and after some initial skirmishes in the north of the state, Union general James G. Blunt pushed south. At Prairie Grove on December 7, 1862, he and his small army defeated a hastily created Confederate force led by General Thomas C. Hindman.